GOVERNANCE STARTER KIT

Six artifacts, filled in

From "First Decision by Day 90" · Reginal Campbell, PMP

> Governance fails when it becomes a reporting factory. It works when it forces clear, accountable decisions. Here's how I'd get to the first one by Day 90.

Every artifact in this kit supports a decision, and every one uses the same sample portfolio and numbers:

Program	Sponsor	Budget	Why it matters
A. Collaboration platform migration	VP, Workplace Technology	$1.2M	Touches every department.
B. Customer portal release	VP, Digital Experience	$900K	Fixed public launch date: Week 16.
C. Identity and access consolidation	Chief Information Security Officer	$600K	Audit fieldwork starts Week 18.

One 6-person integration engineering team serves B and C. On Day 47 the shared RAID log shows both booking it for Weeks 10–15. The artifacts follow that conflict from first signal to executive decision.

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All programs, people, figures and decisions on this page are illustrative. They show a method, not a description of any real organization or engagement. The plan is a starting hypothesis I would test against the real portfolio in the first 30 days.

Decision rights matrix ILLUSTRATIVE

ARTIFACT 1

For: Everyone in governance. When: Set at Day 30; reviewed at the retro. Supports: Who owns each yes and no.

R does the work · A decides (one per row) · C consulted · I informed

Decision	Exec Sponsor	Steering	TPM Director	Program Lead	Shared-Resource Owner	Control Owner	Business Owner
Scope change within one program	I	I	C	**A/R**	C	C	C
Scope change affecting another program	I	**A**	R	C	C	C	C
Budget change up to 10%	I	I	**A**	R			C
Budget change over 10%	C	**A**	R	C		C	I
Schedule slip up to 2 weeks		I	**A**	R	C		I
Schedule slip over 2 weeks	C	**A**	R	C	C		C
Shared resource conflict between programs	I	**A**	R	C	C		I
Risk acceptance (security or compliance)	C	I	R	C		**A**	I
Go-live approval	I	C	R	R		C	**A**
Pause or stop a program	**A**	R	R	C	I	C	C

> Go-live belongs to the business owner, not IT. Delivery proves readiness; the business decides to launch.

Stoplight status card: no watermelon statuses ILLUSTRATIVE

For: Everyone who reports or reads status. When: Set at Day 30. Supports: What every color means.

A watermelon status is green on the outside and red on the inside. These criteria make status a measurement, not a mood.

	Green	Yellow	Red
Schedule	Milestones within 5 business days of plan	Forecast slip of 6 days to 2 weeks	Forecast slip over 2 weeks
Budget	Within 5% of plan	5% to 10% variance	Over 10% variance
Scope	Baseline unchanged, or changes approved	A change is pending a decision inside the program	A change affects another program or the business outcome
Resources	Committed people available in their window	A gap the program can cover itself	A gap that needs people from another program
Risk	No open high-severity risks	A high-severity risk with an owner and a mitigation	No viable mitigation, or a control failure
What it means	Proceed.	Recoverable inside the program. A named owner has a recovery date.	Recovery needs a decision at steering.

FOUR RULES

1. Nothing goes red without going yellow first.
2. Every yellow has an owner and a recovery date. A yellow without both is reported as red.
3. Status describes the forecast, not just today.
4. The program lead reports the color; the criteria decide it. Anyone can challenge a color by pointing to the criteria.

ESCALATION THRESHOLDS

A shared team is unavailable in its committed window	TPM Director, then Steering	1 business day
A milestone is at risk (over 2 weeks)	Steering	Next steering, or called within 5 business days
Budget variance (over 10%)	Steering	Next steering
Security or compliance issue	Control Owner and Exec Sponsor	24 hours

RAID log excerpt, as of Day 52 ILLUSTRATIVE

ARTIFACT 3

For: Program leads, shared-resource and control owners. When: Live; reviewed every two weeks. Supports: What needs escalating, and when.

ID	Type	Program	Description	Owner	Impact	Status	Next action
R-011	Risk	A	Pilot users not completing training before Wave 2 cutover	Business Owner, A	Adoption below target	Yellow	Add floor-walker support, Day 55
D-004	Dependency	A → C	The collaboration suite needs C's single sign-on before Wave 2	Program Lead, C	A's Wave 2 slips if SSO slips	Green	Confirm SSO readiness date, Day 58
A-006	Assumption	C	The SSO vendor's connector supports the two legacy finance apps	Program Lead, C	3 weeks of rework if wrong	Yellow	Vendor proof of concept, Day 57
I-007	Issue	B / C	Integration engineering is committed to B (960 hrs) and C (720 hrs) in Weeks 10–15. Capacity is 1,440 hrs: a 240-hour shortfall.	TPM Director	B's launch date or C's audit readiness	Red	Steering 2 decision, Day 60
R-013	Risk	C	Audit fieldwork in Week 18 finds privileged accounts not yet cleaned up	Control Owner	Audit finding	Yellow	Tied to the outcome of I-007
R-009	Risk	B	Payment provider certification takes longer than planned	Program Lead, B	1 to 2 week launch slip	Green	Certification submitted; track weekly

I-007 was logged as risk R-012 on Day 47, became an issue on Day 48 under the 1-business-day rule, and went to steering because the fix needs people from another program.

Steering pre-read · Steering 2, Day 60 ILLUSTRATIVE

For: Steering members. When: Three business days before each steering. Supports: The one decision on the agenda.

DECISION REQUESTED

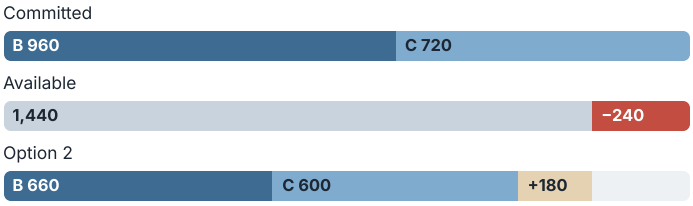
Choose how to resolve the integration engineering conflict between Program B and Program C in Weeks 10–15.

SITUATION

- The 6-person integration team is committed to Program B's launch (960 hours) and Program C's cutover (720 hours) in the same six weeks.
- Available capacity is 1,440 hours. The shortfall is 240 hours.
- B's Week 16 launch date has been announced to customers. C's privileged-account cleanup must finish before audit fieldwork starts in Week 18.

Both plans assumed the team's full availability. Neither could see the other's peak. (The shared RAID log is what surfaced it.)

INTEGRATION ENGINEERING, WEEKS 10–15 (HOURS)



OPTIONS

OPTION 1

Sequence

Finish B first, then C.

Hours
B 960; C deferred

Schedule
B holds. C slips about 6 weeks.

Cost
None added

Risk
Audit finding likely: cleanup misses Week 18.

Reversible?
Yes

OPTION 2 · RECOMMENDED

Phase scope

B launches with core scope; two non-critical integrations (notification preferences, analytics export) follow by Week 20. C does its audit-critical work first: privileged accounts and finance apps.

Hours
B 660 + C 600 = 1,260 (180-hour buffer)

Schedule
B's date holds. C's audit-critical work holds. The rest of C follows after Week 16.

Cost
None added

Risk
The business owner accepts a reduced launch scope.

Reversible?
Yes. Deferred scope ships by Week 20.

OPTION 3

Add capacity

Two contract integration engineers for six weeks.

Hours
1,440 + about 480 contract hours

Schedule
Both hold, if onboarding takes under 2 weeks.

Cost
About $72K: 12% of C's budget, over the 10% threshold

Risk
Onboarding uses a third of the window. Knowledge leaves with the contractors.

Reversible?
Partly. Spend is committed.

RECOMMENDATION

Option 2. It protects both external commitments at no added cost and leaves a 180-hour buffer. Get contractor pricing now as a fallback, to decide by Day 74 if the buffer is used up.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

- **Business Owner, B:** Accept the reduced launch scope and the Week 20 follow-up.
- **Control Owner:** Confirm the audit-critical scope matches what the auditors will test.
- **Steering:** Approve Option 2 and the fallback trigger.

If we don't decide on Day 60: The team starts Week 10 double-booked. Work goes to whoever asks loudest, and both commitments are at risk.

Executive one-pager · Day 90 ILLUSTRATIVE

ARTIFACT 5

For: Exec sponsor and business owners. When: Each executive readout. Supports: Proceed, pivot, slow or stop.

DECISION NEEDED

Approve Proceed for Program B's Week 16 launch with core scope. Approve Slow for Program A's Wave 3 until adoption reaches target.

Program	Status	Confidence	Trend	One line
A. Collaboration platform migration	Yellow	Medium	→	Delivered on time; adoption is short of target.
B. Customer portal release	Green	High	↑	Go-live readiness criteria met. Deferred scope on track for Week 20.
C. Identity and access consolidation	Green	Medium	↑	Audit-critical scope 85% complete. On track for Week 18.

VALUE AT RISK

If A's adoption stalls, the license consolidation savings planned for Wave 3 slip by about a quarter.

TOP THREE RISKS

1. A's adoption: 70% of Wave 1–2 users active, against an 80% target. Owner: Business Owner, A.
2. C's legacy connector proof of concept passed for one of two finance apps; the second needs a workaround. Owner: Program Lead, C.
3. B's payment certification is on track; the fallback date is held. Owner: Program Lead, B.

WHAT CHANGED SINCE STEERING 2

Option 2 was carried out. The contractor fallback wasn't needed and was closed on Day 74. C moved from yellow to green.

DELIVERY

9 of 10

milestones on time; decision turnaround averages 3 days

ADOPTION

70%

of A's users active, against an 80% target

OPERATIONAL

2.1

support tickets per 100 users on A, trending down

THE FOUR CALLS

Proceed: criteria met and controls in place. **Pivot:** the evidence favors a different approach. **Slow:** capacity or adoption is short, so scope is sequenced. **Stop:** criteria still unmet after one revision.

Decision log, Days 1–90 ILLUSTRATIVE

ARTIFACT 6

For: Everyone in governance. When: Updated within 24 hours of each decision. Supports: What was decided, on what evidence, and when to revisit it.

#	Day	Forum	Decision	Decided by	Basis	Revisit if
001	30	Steering 1	Approved the governance charter, decision rights and cadence.	Steering	Stakeholder intake; portfolio inventory	Governance retro at Day 90
002	30	Steering 1	Adopted the stoplight status criteria and escalation thresholds.	Steering	Inconsistent status formats found in intake	Two or more color disputes in a month
003	41	Program review	Moved A's Wave 2 by one week to finish training (within tolerance).	TPM Director	R-011; slip under 2 weeks	Training completion below 90%
004	48	TPM escalation	Paused new requests to integration engineering until Steering 2.	TPM Director	I-007; 1-business-day rule	Steering 2 decision
005	60	Steering 2	Approved Option 2: phased scope for B, audit-critical scope first for C.	Steering, with B's business owner	Pre-read options analysis	Buffer falls below 80 hours
006	74	Steering	Contractor fallback not needed; closed.	Steering	Buffer at 150 hours	None
007	90	Executive Readout	Proceed: B launches Week 16. Slow: A's Wave 3 waits until adoption reaches 80%.	Exec Sponsor and business owners	Readiness criteria; scorecard	Adoption at 80% for two weeks running

> The "Revisit if" column is the point: a decision should change when the evidence changes, and everyone should know in advance what evidence that is.

> A recommendation should change when the evidence changes. Accountability for delivery should not.